予 想 問 題　第 2 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

秋田大学（国際資源学部・教育文化学部・医学部保健学科・情報データ科学部 共通問題）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜9ページ・解答用紙 10〜10ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は60分。大問は Ⅰ〜Ⅲ の3題。Ⅰ・Ⅱは英文の設問に記号 (A)〜(D) で答え，Ⅲは英語で1段落の文章を書く。
3. 配点は Ⅰ 70点・Ⅱ 70点・Ⅲ 60点（計200点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
4. 本冊子の英文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

秋田大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

I 長文読解（配点 70点）

Study the article and respond to each question by choosing one of the four options. Write the letter of the option you choose.

The Village That Switched Off the Night

[1] When Corin Pask was a boy, he could lie on the grass behind his parents' farm in the village of Carrow Fell and watch the pale band of stars we call the Milky Way stretching across the sky. By the time his own daughter was born, it had disappeared. Nothing had happened to the stars themselves. What had changed was the light on the ground: brighter streetlights along the new road, floodlights at a garden centre, and security lamps on almost every house.

[2] Scientists call this problem light pollution. Across much of the globe, the night sky is now so bright that most residents have never seen more than a handful of stars. Unlike other kinds of pollution, it leaves no smell and no rubbish behind, so it is easy to overlook. Yet researchers have linked too much artificial lighting after dark to poorer sleep in humans, and to confusion among birds, insects and other animals that rely on darkness.

[3] Six years ago, Pask, who now chairs the village council, persuaded his neighbours to try something unusual. Instead of adding more lights, Carrow Fell would reduce them. The aim was to be recognised as a dark-sky village, a title given to places that keep their night skies unusually dark. To earn it, the village had to measure the brightness of its sky regularly and show that it was controlling outdoor lighting.

[4] The changes were mostly practical. Old streetlights, which scattered light in every direction, were replaced with lamps that point downwards and give off a warmer, yellower glow. Lights in the car park were fitted with timers so that they switched off at midnight. Residents were offered free shades for their security lamps, which stop the light from spilling into the sky and into their neighbours' bedrooms.

[5] Not everyone welcomed the plan. Some older residents worried that darker streets would make it easier for burglars* to break into homes, and that walking home at night would become dangerous. At the first public meeting, one man asked whether the council intended to "send the village back to the Middle Ages". Pask admits that the fear was understandable. "People connect light with safety," he says. "We had to show them that better lighting does not mean more lighting."

[6] To answer these concerns, the council asked the local police to share crime figures for the village before and after the change. Over the following three years, the number of reported break-ins did not rise. A police officer told a later meeting that badly aimed lights can actually help criminals by creating deep shadows and dazzling* anyone who looks towards them.

Gradually, opposition faded, and several of the plan's strongest critics now offer to help with sky measurements.

[7] There were also benefits that few people had expected. The new lamps use far less electricity than the old ones, and the village's energy bill for street lighting fell by nearly half. That money has been spent on repairing the village hall. Meanwhile, a local naturalist who counts moths each summer has recorded a steady increase in their numbers, although she is careful to point out that the weather may also play a part.

[8] The most visible change, however, has been in tourism. Once Carrow Fell received its dark-sky title, visitors began to arrive in winter, a season when the village used to be almost empty. A former barn now houses a small observatory, and the pub now holds "star suppers", at which guests eat by candlelight before going outside with a guide. For a village that had been losing young people for decades, the new jobs have been welcome.

[9] Some astronomers, though, warn that success can bring its own problems. A rise in visitors brings a rise in cars, and headlights in narrow lanes can spoil the very darkness that people have come to see. Carrow Fell now asks visitors to park on the outskirts of the village and walk the last few hundred metres with red torches, which affect night vision less than white ones. Whether this arrangement will work if visitor numbers keep growing is still an open question.

[10] Pask insists that the project was never only about astronomy. For him, it concerns the kind of place people want to live in. "We put much effort into protecting old buildings and beautiful views," he says. "The night sky is part of our landscape, too. It belonged to our grandparents, and it should belong to our grandchildren."

[11] Last winter, Pask took his daughter, now twelve, to the field behind the old farm. They lay on a blanket and waited for their eyes to adjust. After about twenty minutes, the Milky Way slowly appeared, just as he remembered it. His daughter said nothing for several minutes. Then she asked why nobody had told her it was there.

burglars　泥棒，押し込み強盗
dazzling　（強い光で）目をくらませる

問 1　Why had the Milky Way vanished from Corin Pask's view by the time his daughter was born, according to Paragraph [1]?

(A) The stars had become fainter.
(B) He had moved away from the farm.
(C) There was much more artificial light on the ground.
(D) The weather had become cloudier.

問 2 Which option is closest in sense to ***overlook*** in Paragraph [2]?

(A) fail to notice

(B) look down from above

(C) clean up

(D) measure carefully

問 3 What did Carrow Fell have to do to become a dark-sky village, as explained in Paragraph [3]?

(A) build an observatory for visitors

(B) switch off every light in the village

(C) check how bright its sky was and control outdoor lights

(D) ask all residents to move out at night

問 4 Which of these changes is NOT described in Paragraph [4]?

(A) Streetlights that send light downwards were put in.

(B) Lights in the car park were set to go off at midnight.

(C) Residents were given shades for their security lamps.

(D) Every house was required to turn off its lights at ten.

問 5 What did some older residents fear, according to Paragraph [5]?

(A) that crime might increase on darker streets

(B) that tourists would fill the village

(C) that the new lamps would be too expensive

(D) that the stars would still be invisible

問 6 What point is the writer making in Paragraph [6]?

(A) The police refused to share any crime figures.

(B) Break-ins rose sharply after the change.

(C) The fear that darker streets would bring more crime was groundless.

(D) The critics of the plan left the village.

問 7 In Paragraph [7], why is the naturalist careful about her moth counts?

(A) She thinks the counts were made incorrectly.

(B) Other causes, such as the weather, might explain the increase.

(C) The number of moths has actually fallen.

(D) She does not believe light affects insects.

問 8 How has tourism in Carrow Fell changed, as described in Paragraph [8]?

(A) Visitors now come in winter, when the village used to be quiet.

(B) Fewer visitors come because the village is too dark.

(C) The pub has closed because too few guests came.

(D) Young people have continued to leave for the cities.

問 9 What does ***an open question*** in Paragraph [9] suggest?

(A) Everyone is free to ask the council questions.

(B) Visitors must ask permission before entering.

(C) The arrangement has already been shown to fail.

(D) Nobody knows yet whether the arrangement will keep working.

問 10 Which statement is inconsistent with the article?

(A) The money saved on electricity was used to repair the village hall.

(B) Red torches affect night vision less than white ones.

(C) Pask believes the night sky should be protected like a landscape.

(D) Pask's daughter had often seen the Milky Way before last winter.

II 長文読解（配点 70点）

Study the article and respond to each question by choosing one of the four options. Write the letter of the option you choose.

Four Days of Lessons, One Day of Something Else

[1] Every Friday morning, the corridors of Bramwell Valley School are silent. The classrooms are locked, the buses stay in their garage, and the school's 340 pupils are somewhere else entirely. Three years ago, this rural school became one of a small but growing number that teach lessons on only four days a week. The school day is about fifty minutes longer from Monday to Thursday, so the total number of teaching hours has hardly changed.

[2] The decision was not made because of a new theory about learning. It began with a much more practical problem: the school could not find enough teachers. Bramwell Valley lies more than an hour's drive from the nearest city, and for several years in a row, advertisements for maths and science posts received no applications at all. The head teacher, Nadia Coombe, says she was spending more time searching for staff than thinking about lessons.

[3] A four-day week, she hoped, would make the job more attractive. Teachers would have one weekday to plan lessons, mark work, attend training or simply rest. The plan seemed to pay off. In the first year after the change, the school received more than three times as many applications as before, and two teachers who had been planning to leave decided to stay. "It had been years since I last chose between candidates instead of begging people to come," Coombe says.

[4] There were savings, too. With no buses running on Fridays and the heating turned down in empty buildings, the school spent noticeably less on transport and energy. Coombe is quick to add, however, that saving money was never the main goal, and that the amounts involved were smaller than some newspapers reported.

[5] For pupils, the effects have been mixed. Many say they like the longer weekend, and attendance on the remaining four days has improved slightly. Some older students use Fridays for part-time jobs, while others catch up on homework or take part in sports. But the longer school day is tiring, especially for the youngest children, and several teachers have noticed that concentration drops sharply in the final lesson of the afternoon.

[6] The biggest worry concerns families. When the school is closed, someone has to look after the children who are too young to stay at home alone. Parents with flexible jobs, or with grandparents nearby, have managed fairly easily. For others, especially single parents and those working in shops or factories, Fridays have become a weekly headache. Some have had to pay for childcare they cannot really afford.

[7] To ease this burden, the school now opens its hall on Fridays for an optional programme run by local volunteers and community groups. Children can join a cooking club, help on a nearby farm, or learn first aid. The programme is free, but places are limited, and it does not count as formal teaching. Critics say it is a stopgap rather than a solution: a sensible short-term measure that does not answer the deeper question of who should take responsibility for children on a weekday.

[8] What about learning itself? Here the evidence is far from clear. Exam results at Bramwell Valley have stayed roughly the same since the change. Studies of four-day schools elsewhere have produced conflicting results: some find small falls in achievement, particularly in maths, while others find no difference at all. Researchers caution that schools which adopt a four-day week tend to be small and rural, which makes it hard to compare them fairly with other schools.

[9] Supporters of the idea argue that the extra day can be valuable in itself. A day without lessons, they say, gives young people time to develop interests that a crowded timetable leaves no room for. Opponents reply that this only works for children whose families can offer them something worthwhile to do. For pupils from poorer homes, an unstructured day may simply mean more hours in front of a screen.

[10] Coombe herself is cautious. She does not recommend the four-day week to every school, and she says that the arrangement is reviewed every year. “It solved a staffing crisis that was threatening the whole school,” she says. “But I would not pretend it has no costs. Those costs fall most heavily on the families with the least room to cope, and we have a duty to keep looking for ways to help them.”

[11] For now, the experiment continues. Last month, the school asked parents and pupils whether they wanted to keep the four-day week. Just over sixty per cent said yes. It was a clear majority, but not an overwhelming one, and Coombe is aware that the families who said no are often the ones whose voices are hardest to hear.

問 1 According to Paragraph [1], how has the total number of teaching hours changed?

(A) It has been cut by one fifth.

(B) It has stayed almost the same.

(C) It has nearly doubled.

(D) It has risen because of Friday lessons.

問 2 What led the school to change its timetable, according to Paragraph [2]?

(A) a new theory about how children learn

(B) a long-lasting difficulty in hiring teachers

(C) a request from the parents of young pupils

(D) a plan to spend less money on school buses

問 3 Which option is closest in sense to ***pay off*** in Paragraph [3]?

(A) succeed

(B) cost money

(C) be cancelled

(D) be delayed

問 4 What does Coombe add about the savings in Paragraph [4]?

(A) Saving money was the main reason for the change.

(B) The savings were larger than newspapers had reported.

(C) Saving money was not the main goal, and the amounts were fairly small.

(D) The school still runs its buses on Fridays.

問 5 Which drawback for pupils is mentioned in Paragraph [5]?

(A) Attendance has fallen on the remaining days.

(B) The long school day is tiring for younger children.

(C) Older students are no longer allowed to work.

(D) The weekend has become shorter than before.

問 6 Which families have found Fridays hardest to manage, as described in Paragraph [6]?

(A) families with grandparents living nearby

(B) parents whose working hours are flexible

(C) the families of teachers at the school

(D) single parents and people working in shops or factories

問 7 What do the critics mean by calling the Friday programme a ***stopgap*** in Paragraph [7]?

(A) It is a permanent answer to the problem.

(B) It is a temporary measure that does not solve the deeper problem.

(C) It is a club that only teachers can join.

(D) It is an empty slot in the timetable that should be filled with exams.

問 8 Why do researchers say four-day schools are hard to judge fairly, as explained in Paragraph [8]?

(A) Their exam results are kept secret.

(B) Most of them have stopped teaching maths.

(C) They are usually small schools in rural areas.

(D) They refuse to take part in any studies.

問 9 What do opponents of the idea argue in Paragraph [9]?

(A) Only children whose families can offer worthwhile activities really benefit.

(B) A day without lessons is always valuable for every child.

(C) Poorer families do not have any screens at home.

(D) The timetable is already too empty for most pupils.

問 10 Which statement is inconsistent with the article?

(A) Coombe does not suggest that every school should copy Bramwell Valley.

(B) More than eighty per cent of those asked wanted to keep the four-day week.

(C) The four-day week is reviewed once a year.

(D) The Friday programme is free, but the number of places is limited.

III 自由英作文（配点 60点）

More and more shops and restaurants in Japan now accept cashless payments, such as cards and smartphone apps, and some no longer accept cash at all.

Describe one benefit and one drawback of this change for people living in Japan, giving an example for each. Write a single paragraph in English of approximately 120 words in the box on the answer form.

解答用紙　予想問題 第2回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。Ⅰ・Ⅱは記号 (A)〜(D) を書く。

Ⅰ

問 1	問 2	問 3	問 4	問 5	問 6	問 7	問 8	問 9	問 10

Ⅱ

問 1	問 2	問 3	問 4	問 5	問 6	問 7	問 8	問 9	問 10

Ⅲ（approximately 120 words）

20語

40語

60語

80語

100語

120語

奥付

予想問題 第2回　英語　問題

対象：秋田大学 前期日程 英語（国際資源学部・教育文化学部・医学部保健学科・情報データ科学部 共通問題）の受験準備

作成：学習アプリ マナトビ 編集部（2026年11月）

作成方法：2024〜2026年度の出題形式・分量・難易度を分析し，英文・設問をすべて新たに書き下ろした。

> **秋田大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。**

本冊子の英文は実在の記事・書籍・論文・統計からの引用・翻案ではありません。登場する人物・団体・地名・数値は架空です。無断転載・再配布を禁じます。